

Steve Buzonas

Senior Engineering Leader // Cloud Architect

 buzonas.dev

 Pulaski, PA

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Cloud

AWS (expert) • Azure • GCP
OCI • Heroku

Kubernetes & Containerization

EKS • AKS • ArgoCD • Helm
Service Mesh • API Gateway

IaC & Automation

Terraform • CloudFormation
Packer • Ansible

Observability

ELK • Splunk • New Relic
Datadog

Languages

PHP • NodeJS • TypeScript
Python • Ruby • Go • Java
Scala • Swift • Objective-C
C# • R • S • Flex • ColdFusion

summary

Senior Engineering Leader & Cloud Architect with 20+ years of experience driving cloud modernization, platform engineering, and large-scale DevOps/SRE transformations. Proven track record leading Kubernetes, GitOps, and cloud-native adoption across enterprise health-care environments, including HIPAA-regulated workloads. Expert in building secure, resilient, cost-efficient cloud platforms and shaping executive technology strategy. Adept at aligning architecture, security, and financial objectives to deliver measurable improvements in reliability, velocity, and operational efficiency.

competencies

Cloud Architecture & Modernization

Enterprise cloud design, workload migration, resilience engineering, multi-cloud strategy (AWS, Azure, GCP)

Kubernetes & Platform Engineering

EKS, GitOps (ArgoCD), multi-tenant platforms, service mesh, infrastructure modularization

DevOps & SRE Leadership

Reliability engineering, incident response, observability, CI/CD automation, developer platform design

Security & Compliance

HIPAA-aligned architectures, zero-trust, IAM, encryption standards, governance frameworks

Cost Optimization & FinOps

Cloud cost strategy, workload right-sizing, governance guardrails, budget alignment

Technical Leadership & Strategy

Executive advising, architecture roadmaps, engineering maturity, operating model design

Systems Architecture & Distributed Systems

High availability, performance tuning, data pipelines, event-driven systems

Cross-Functional Leadership

Partnering with security, finance, product, compliance, and engineering leadership teams

Team Development & Coaching

Mentoring engineers, elevating engineering culture, modernizing practices

Consulting & Stakeholder Engagement

Communicating complex technical decisions, guiding org-wide technology transformation

experience

- 2023-2026

Senior Manager, Cloud - Architecture, Envision Healthcare

Remote

Led enterprise cloud architecture and platform engineering strategy across a HIPAA-regulated AWS environment spanning **200+ accounts**, **19 EKS clusters**, and **400+ workloads**. Guided modernization, governance, and reliability initiatives supporting 12+ engineering teams while advising executive leadership on cloud investment, security posture, and long-term platform strategy.

 - **Owned enterprise AWS architecture**, defining SCP guardrails, IAM boundaries, and Account Factory/Terraform patterns that standardized provisioning and governance across 200+ accounts.
 - **Architected and operated the Kubernetes platform**, modernizing 19 EKS clusters with GitOps (ArgoCD), OPA policy-as-code, multi-tenant isolation, and hardened baseline configurations.
 - **Unified cloud networking strategy**, defining VPC standards, Transit Gateway topologies, Direct Connect architecture, and hybrid connectivity patterns in partnership with network engineering.
 - **Advanced platform reliability**, implementing SRE practices, observability standards, and incident response playbooks that reduced MTTR by **40%** and change failure rate by **30%** across 25+ services.
 - **Drove AI/ML enablement**, shaping early guardrails, SDLC workflows, and compliance patterns for safe, ethical adoption of AI-assisted engineering.
 - **Modernized legacy workloads**, consolidating fragmented infrastructure, reducing operational complexity, and improving resilience and scalability across mission-critical systems.
 - **Contributed to a unified cloud operating model**, standardizing tooling, processes, and architectural patterns to improve developer experience and operational consistency.
 - **Served as senior advisor to executive leadership**, influencing multi-year modernization strategy, cloud investment priorities, and enterprise security posture.
- 2021-2023

Senior Manager, Cloud - Infrastructure, Envision Healthcare

Remote

Directed cloud platform strategy, operations, and modernization for enterprise healthcare workloads. Led platform engineering initiatives across infrastructure enablement, developer experience, observability, and governance.

 - **Delivered 40% cloud cost reduction** through RDS right-sizing, Graviton adoption PB-scale S3 lifecycle policies, and FinOps integration into IaC workflows.
 - **Standardized Kubernetes platform patterns**, including GitOps, service mesh, multi-tenant cluster design, and secure-by-default configurations.
 - **Established enterprise observability frameworks**, implementing distributed tracing, metrics pipelines, and logging architectures supporting 12+ engineering teams.
 - **Strengthened HIPAA-aligned governance**, embedding IAM guardrails, encryption standards, and policy automation across AWS and Azure workloads.
 - **Influenced enterprise cloud strategy**, participating in the Architecture Review Board, Security Roadmap, and Migration & Modernization leadership forums.
 - **Improved developer experience**, driving adoption of internal platform tooling, CI/CD modernization, and infrastructure automation patterns.
- 2018-2021

DevOps Consultant, Envision Healthcare

Remote

Supported enterprise DevOps transformation, platform standardization, and cloud governance initiatives.

 - **Implemented AWS Config rules and OPA policy-as-code**, enforcing governance across AWS and Kubernetes environments.
 - **Contributed to CSPM evaluation and security posture improvements**, including encryption enforcement and identity-centric patterns.
 - **Optimized cloud costs** through right-sizing, governance guardrails, and FinOps reporting.
 - **Guided platform standardization**, improving reliability, security, and operational consistency across engineering teams.

- 2017-2018 **DevOps Engineer, Tripcraft.com** Remote
Provided platform engineering leadership across multi-client AWS environments, supporting distributed development teams and modernizing operational practices.
- Standardized AWS account operations, service catalog offerings, and environment provisioning patterns across multiple client workloads.
 - Supported Ruby, Scala, and React engineering teams with platform tooling, CI/CD improvements, and deployment automation.
 - Operated and optimized MongoDB clusters, improving performance and reliability for multi-team delivery pipelines.
 - Strengthened DevOps maturity by introducing repeatable operational workflows and improving cross-team collaboration.
- 2016-2017 **Senior Backend Web Developer, Carnegie Learning** Pittsburgh, PA
Led backend engineering and modernization efforts for core education platforms, establishing foundational DevOps and architectural practices that improved scalability and delivery velocity.
- Migrated ECS workloads to Fargate, reducing operational overhead and improving service scalability.
 - Defined next-generation architectural patterns for future product initiatives, influencing long-term technical direction.
 - Modernized legacy services to eliminate bottlenecks, improve reliability, and support higher availability requirements.
 - Led backend development team responsible for key web applications, providing technical direction and mentoring.
 - Established the organization's first DevOps department, defining policies, hiring engineering talent, and building operational foundations.
 - Oversaw day-to-day DevOps operations and contributed to long-term roadmap execution.
 - Served as Scrum Master, improving delivery cadence and cross-functional alignment.
- 2014-2016 **Backend Web Developer, Carnegie Learning** Pittsburgh, PA
Drove early cloud adoption and DevOps transformation, modernizing infrastructure and improving developer experience.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines that accelerated feature delivery and reduced deployment friction.
 - Migrated infrastructure from vSphere colocation to AWS, improving scalability and operational resilience.
 - Ensured immutable infrastructure using OpsWorks and Packer, establishing early infrastructure-as-code patterns.
 - Coached development teams transitioning to agile workflows, improving collaboration and delivery predictability.

- 2012-2013 **Developer, GiftCards.com** Pittsburgh, PA
Modernized legacy systems and guided the transition toward service-oriented architecture for high-volume e-commerce platforms.
- Led architectural roadmap efforts to transition legacy systems to SOA, improving scalability and maintainability.
 - Introduced SYmfony and Twig to modernize WordPress development and standardize engineering practices.
 - Designed a domain-specific language for fraud rule management, building the compiler, lexer, and parser to improve rule accuracy and reduce operational overhead.
 - Conducted vulnerability assessments and code quality reviews, strengthening security posture.
 - Ensured PCI-DSS compliance for all in-scope systems.
 - Implemented CI pipelines and administered Atlassian tooling, improving developer productivity and operational consistency.
- 2011-2012 **Project Manager & iOS Developer, BlackDog Creative Group** Remote
Led distributed engineering teams and delivered cross-platform applications for clients across multiple industries.
- Managed distributed teams of developers, QA, UX, and designers, ensuring alignment and delivery across complex projects.
 - Build PHP frameworks, Adobe AIR/Flex applications, OCR libraries, and NetBeans tooling to support client workflows.
 - Developed REST services and offline-first CMS systems, improving reliability and user experience.
 - Integrated WordPress with QuickBooks to streamline inventory and operational processes.
- 2005-2009 **VP - IT, Greater Pittsburgh Glass & Door** Pittsburgh, PA
Drove early cloud adoption and built foundational business systems that improved operational efficiency and supported company growth.
- Designed business systems, CRM/ERP workflows, and IVR/VOIP solutions tailored to operational needs.
 - Led early cloud migration to Amazon S3 and EC2 beta, reducing infrastructure costs and improving reliability.
 - Modernized internal processes through automation and system integration, improving productivity across departments.
- 2001-2004 **Systems Administration Supervisor - INET Financial** McKees Rocks, PA
Built scalable SaaS systems and improved database performance for multi-tenant financial applications.
- Developed SaaS systems supporting franchise environments, enabling consistent deployment and centralized management.
 - Improved database architecture and performance, supporting platform growth and higher transaction volumes.
 - Built PHP extensions enabling desktop integrations and improving partner workflows.

consulting (select engagements)

Modernization & Cloud Architecture

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|------------|---|----------------|
| since 2005 | President & Principal Consultant, FancyGuy Technologies
Independent practice delivering cloud architecture, DevOps/SRE, and modernization across multiple industries and scales | Pittsburgh, PA |
| 2018-2019 | AWS Solutions Architect, Course Cafe <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Reduced AWS costs, built CI/CD pipelines, and implemented SecOps audit trails | Remote |
| 2012 | High Availability Consultant, Reed & Witting <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Designed high-availability IaaS and modernized legacy PHP4 applications | Pittsburgh, PA |

Search / Data Engineering

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|-----------|---|--------|
| 2019 | Consultant, Bain & Company <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Improved Elasticsearch performance, developed Lucene extensions, designed analyzers/tokenizers, and upgraded clusters | Remote |
| 2018-2019 | RDS Administrator, Boost Media <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Optimized Aurora performance and executed zero-downtime migration of 3TB workloads | Remote |
| 2017-2018 | Solutions Architect, Engeo <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Delivered architectural proposals with cost analyses | Remote |

DevOps & Engineering Enablement

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|-----------|---|--------|
| 2018-2020 | Consultant, Surge IT Services <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Developed interview metrics and conducted technical hiring assessments• Performed code reviews for Scala, Kotlin, and Java• Supported developers with DevOps tooling and processes | Remote |
| 2018-2019 | CloudFormation Developer, Agency Marketing Machine <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Built on-demand CloudFormation templates and integrated WordPress multi-site deployments | Remote |

military

2004-2012	Corporal, United States Marine Corps Developed the leadership foundation that shaped later engineering and operational excellence.	MWSS 471 Det A
	• Led and mentored junior Marines in high-pressure, mission-critical environments, instilling discipline, accountability, and readiness. • Oversaw information assurance and cryptologic responsibilities, reinforcing unit security posture and safeguarding sensitive communications. • Coordinated daily operations, resource allocation, and mission support activities, ensuring operational efficiency and reliability. • Recognized for adaptability and leadership under stress—strengths directly applied to engineering, incident response, and cloud operations. • Build cross-functional collaboration skills through joint tasks with logistics, communications, and command staff.	

certifications

2026-2029	AWS Certified Solutions Architect	Professional
2026-2029	AWS Certified DevOps Engineer	Professional
2026-2029	AWS Certified Security	Specialty